

# Tonderai Assan Saidi

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## Professional Profile

Backend Engineer with 4+ years of experience in financial systems, combining strong SOLID design principles with analytical thinking from my mechatronics background. I specialize in high-availability event-driven architectures, RESTful APIs, and distributed systems using Java/Kotlin. Experienced in Spring Boot, PostgreSQL, and AWS/Kubernetes environments, I deliver robust, scalable solutions with rigorous testing practices.

## Professional Experience

**Software Engineer** Present  
*Capitec Bank (Contracting from Entelect) , Cape Town (Telephony Team)*

- Led the design and development of a centralized dashboard providing real-time visibility into AWS Lambda functions, their execution flows, and relationships with key AWS resources — leveraging AWS Step Functions, CloudWatch, and DynamoDB for orchestration and observability
- Delivered a communication platform enabling managers to broadcast emergency messages directly to call centres, ensuring rapid alignment and operational resilience during outages
- Driving the development of an in-house incident management and escalation system to replace PagerDuty — streamlining response workflows, reducing vendor dependency, and integrating tightly with our AWS ecosystem

**Software Engineer** March 2024 - Present  
*Turfsport, Cape Town*

- Migrated core racing platform to Java 17, enhancing security by 30% while improving performance by 15%
- Implemented AWS OpenSearch to optimize large-scale data queries, achieving 10% faster system response
- Standardized documentation processes and automated troubleshooting procedures
- Maintain and enhance frontend dashboards using Angular components, contributing to full stack development

**Software Engineer** July 2021 - March 2024  
*Lipa Payments, Cape Town*

- Developed PCI-compliant microservices and REST APIs for financial products, accelerating third-party integrations
- Led Mastercard Payment Gateway integration project, ensuring secure transaction processing
- Created CI/CD automation tooling in Go, reducing pipeline setup time

**Data Acquisition Engineer** April 2021 - June 2021  
*Energy Partners, Cape Town*

- Built real-time PostgreSQL dashboards for monitoring energy consumption data

## Technical Skills

| Languages                 | Frameworks & Tools                                          | Infrastructure                                      |
|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Java, Kotlin, Python, SQL | Spring Boot, Maven/Gradle<br>JUnit, React-Native, Git, Jira | AWS EKS, Kubernetes<br>SQL, Docker, RabbitMQ, NoSQL |

## Education & Achievements

**BScEng (Hons) Mechatronics** 2017 - 2020 **Languages**  
University of Cape Town • English (C1) • Shona (B1)

- Dean's List recognition at UCT
- International Programming Olympiad Award
- UCT Mathematics Olympiad Award

Open to relocation & remote opportunities in Europe (Blue card and Chancekaart eligible)